Mathematical Studies Analysis

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1 The fundamental theorem of calculus

1.1 Differentiation of monotone functions

Continuity

Definition. Let X be a set and $g : X \to [0, \infty)$. Define infinite sum

$$\sum_{x \in X} g(x) := \left\{ \sum_{x \in Y} g(x) : Y \subset X \text{ finite} \right\}.$$

Theorem. Let X be a set and $g : X \to [0, \infty)$. If $\sum_{x \in X} g(x) < \infty$, then $\{x \in X : g(x) > 0\}$ is countable.

Proof. Let $M = \sum_{x \in X} g(x)$ and $X_k = \{x \in X : g(x) > k^{-1}\}$ for $k \in \mathbb{N}$. Let $Y \subset X_k$ finite, then

$$M \geq \sum_{x \in Y} g(x) > k^{-1} |Y| .$$

Hence $|Y| \leq kM$ and thus $|X_k| \leq kM$. It follows that $\{x \in X : g(x) > 0\} = \bigcup_{k=1}^{\infty} X_k$ is countable. □

Theorem. Let $I \subset \mathbb{R}$ be an interval and $f : I \to \mathbb{R}$ an increasing function. Then, f is continuous at all but countably many $x \in I$.

Proof. First assume $I = [a, b]$. Then for $x \in (a, b)$, there exists $\lim_{y \to x^-} f(y) = f(x-)$ and $\lim_{y \to x^+} f(y) = f(x+)$. Since the function is increasing, $f(x+) \geq f(x-)$. Now we can define $g(x) = f(x+) - f(x-)$. It is clear that $\sum_{x \in [a,b]} g(x) \leq f(b) - f(a)$. By the previous theorem, $f(x+) = f(x-)$ for all but countably many $x \in [a, b]$.

The interval $I \subset \mathbb{R}$ can be written as a countable union of finite closed intervals. The proof is then complete. □

Differentiation

Theorem (Lebesgue's differentiation theorem)**.** Let $I \subset \mathbb{R}$ be an interval and let $f : I \to \mathbb{R}$ be a monotone function. Then f is differentiable a.e. on I.

To show this, we need a few lemmas.

Lemma. Let $I \subset \mathbb{R}$ be an interval, let $f : I \to \mathbb{R}$, and let

$$E = \left\{ x \in I^\circ : \text{ there exist } f'_+(x) \text{ and } f'_-(x) \text{ and } f'_+(x) \neq f'_-(x) \right\}.$$

Then E is countable.

Proof. First observe that for any function $g : I \to \mathbb{R}$, the set of its strict local minimum points in I° is countable. Set

$$E_- = \left\{x \in E : f'_-(x) < f'_+(x)\right\}.$$

For every $r \in \mathbb{Q}$, define

$$E_r = \left\{x \in E_- : f'_-(x) < r < f'_+(x)\right\},$$

and let $g_r(t) = f(t) - rt$ for $t \in I$. By density of rationals, $E_- = \bigcup_{r\in\mathbb{Q}} E_r$. If $x \in E_r$, then

$$(g_r)'_-(x) < 0 < (g_r)'_+(x).$$

It follows that $g_r(y) > g_r(x)$ for every $y \neq x$ sufficiently close to x, i.e. x is a strict local minimum point of g_r. Therefore E_r is countable and thus E_- is countable. Applying the same argument to $-f$ completes the proof for the lemma. □

Lemma. Let $E \subset \mathbb{R}$ be bounded, and $\mathcal{F}$ be a family of open intervals such that each $x \in E$ is the left endpoint of an interval $(x, x + h_x) \in \mathcal{F}$. Then there for every $\varepsilon > 0$, there exist disjoint intervals $I_1, \ldots, I_n \in \mathcal{F}$ such that

$$\mathcal{L}^1_o\left(E \cap \bigcup_{k=1}^{n} I_k\right) \geq \mathcal{L}^1_o(E) - \varepsilon.$$

Proof. If $E = \emptyset$, take the empty collection. If $E \neq \emptyset$ and $\mathcal{L}^1_o(E) \leq \varepsilon$, any one interval in $\mathcal{F}$ suffices. Thus assume that $L^1_o(E) > \varepsilon$. For each $x \in E$, choose an interval $(x, x + h_x) \in \mathcal{F}$ and define

$$E_n = \left\{x \in E : h_x > n^{-1}\right\}.$$

Note that $E_n \subset E_{n+1}$ and $E = \bigcup_{n=1}^{\infty} E_n$. By coninuity from below of Lebesgue outer measure (exercise), we have $\mathcal{L}^1_o(E_n) \to \mathcal{L}^1_o(E)$. Hence we can find m large enough such that $\mathcal{L}^1_o(E_m) > \mathcal{L}^1_o(E) - \frac{\varepsilon}{2}$. For each $k \in \mathbb{N}$, let $\eta_k = \varepsilon 2^{-k-1}$, then $\sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \eta_k = \frac{\varepsilon}{2}$.

Let $a_1 = \inf E_m$. By definition of infimum we can find $x_1 \in E_m$ with $a_1 \leq x_1 < a_1 + \eta_1$, and correspondingly $I_1 = (x_1 + h_1) \in \mathcal{F}$ with $h_1 > m^{-1}$. Suppose $I_1, \ldots, I_k$ has been chosen. If $\{x \in E_m : x \geq x_k + h_k\} = \emptyset$, we stop. Otherwise let $a_{k+1} = \inf\{x \in E_m : x \geq x_k + h_k\}$. Then there is $x_{k+1} \in E_m$ such that $a_{k+1} \leq x_{k+1} \leq a_{k+1} + \eta_{k+1}$ and correspondingly $I_{k+1} = (x_{k+1}, x_{k+1} + h_{k+1}) \in \mathcal{F}$ with $h_{k+1} > m^{-1}$. Note that

$$x_{k+1} \geq x_k + h_k > x_k + m^{-1},$$

and $E_m \subset E$ is bounded, the construction must stop after finitely many steps. Moreover, $I_1, \ldots, I_n$ are disjoint by construction.

Now let

$$S = \bigcup_{k=1}^{n} I_n, \quad T = \bigcup_{k=1}^{n} (x_k - \eta_k, x_k].$$

The points of E_m skipped at the k-th step belong to $[a_k, x_k] \subset (x_k - \eta_k, x_k]$. Thus $E_m \subset S \cup T$, then

$$\begin{aligned}\mathcal{L}^1_o(E) - \frac{\varepsilon}{2} < \mathcal{L}^1_o(E_m) &\leq \mathcal{L}^1_o(E_m \cap S) + \mathcal{L}^1_o(E_m \cap T) \\ &\leq \mathcal{L}^1_o(E_m \cap S) + \sum_{k=1}^{n} \eta_k \leq \mathcal{L}^1_o(E_m \cap S) + \frac{\varepsilon}{2}.\end{aligned}$$

This concludes the proof. □

Lemma. Let $E \subset \mathbb{R}$ be bounded, $\mathcal{F}$ be family of open intervals such that for all $x \in E$ and $\delta > 0$, there exists $(x, x + h_x) \in \mathcal{F}$ with $0 \leq h_x < \delta$. Then for all $\varepsilon > 0$, there exists disjoint intervals $I_1, \ldots, I_m \in \mathcal{F}$ such that

$$\mathcal{L}^1_o\left(E \cap \bigcup_{i=1}^{m} I_i\right) \geq \mathcal{L}^1_o(E) - \varepsilon, \quad \sum_{i=1}^{m} \mathcal{L}^1(I_i) \leq \mathcal{L}^1_o(E) + \varepsilon.$$

Proof. By the definiton of Lebesgue outer measure, find an bounded open set $U \supset E$ such that $\mathcal{L}^1_o(U) \leq \mathcal{L}^1_o(E) + \varepsilon$. Let $\mathcal{F}'$ be the subfamily of intervals $(x, x + h_x) \in \mathcal{F}$ contained in U. Note that for each $x \in E \subset U$, there must exists at least one such interval, since U contains a ball centered at x and there are intervals of arbitrarily small length.

Apply the previous lemma to the family $\mathcal{F}'$ to find disjoint intervals $I_1, \ldots, I_n \subset \mathcal{F}'$ such that

$$\mathcal{L}^1_o\left(E \cap \bigcup_{k=1}^{n} I_k\right) \geq \mathcal{L}^1_o(E) - \varepsilon.$$

Since the intervals are disjoint and contined in U, it follows that

$$\sum_{k=1}^{n} \mathcal{L}^1(I_k) \leq \mathcal{L}^1_o(U) \leq \mathcal{L}^1_o(E) + \varepsilon.$$

The proof is then complete. □

Definition. For a function $f : E \to \mathbb{R}$, define

$$\liminf_{x \to x_0} f(x) = \sup_{r>0} \inf_{0<d(x,x_0)<r} f(x), \quad \limsup_{x \to x_0} f(x) = \inf_{r>0} \sup_{0<d(x,x_0)<r} f(x),$$

Exercise. $\liminf_{x \to x_0} f(x) = l \in \mathbb{R}$ iff for every $\varepsilon > 0$:

1. there exists $\delta > 0$ such that $l - \varepsilon < f(x)$ for all $x \in E$ with $0 < d(x, x_0) < \delta$.
2. For every $\delta > 0$, there exists $x \in E$ with $0 < d(x, x_0) < \delta$ such that $f(x) < l + \varepsilon$.

Also, $\liminf_{x \to x_0} f(x) = -\infty$ iff for every $M > 0$ and $\delta > 0$, there exists $x \in E$ with $0 < d(x, x_0) < \delta$ such that $f(x) < -M$.

Now we are ready to show Lebesgue's differentiation theorem. Recall the statement of the theorem below:

Theorem (Lebesgue's differentiation theorem)**.** Let $I \subset \mathbb{R}$ be an interval and let $f : I \to \mathbb{R}$ be a monotone function. Then f is differentiable a.e. on I.

Proof. Define **Dini's derivatives** as follows:

$$\overline{D}_+ f(x_0) = \limsup_{x \to x_0^+} \frac{f(x) - f(x_0)}{x - x_0}, \qquad \underline{D}_+ f(x_0) = \liminf_{x \to x_0^+} \frac{f(x) - f(x_0)}{x - x_0},$$
$$\overline{D}_- f(x_0) = \limsup_{x \to x_0^-} \frac{f(x) - f(x_0)}{x - x_0}, \qquad \underline{D}_- f(x_0) = \liminf_{x \to x_0^-} \frac{f(x) - f(x_0)}{x - x_0}.$$

WLOG assume f is increasing, and assume $I = [a, b]$. Let

$$\begin{aligned} E &= \left\{x \in I^\circ : \underline{D}_+ f(x) < \overline{D}_+ f(x)\right\} \\ &= \bigcup_{\substack{r,s \in \mathbb{Q} \\ 0<r<s}} \left\{x \in I^\circ : \underline{D}_+ f(x) < r < s < \overline{D}_+ f(x)\right\} \\ &= \bigcup_{\substack{r,s \in \mathbb{Q} \\ 0<r<s}} E_{r,s} \end{aligned}$$

It suffices to show that $\mathcal{L}^1(E_{r,s}) = 0$. Let $\varepsilon > 0$ be given.

Let $x \in E_{r,s}$. We have

$$\liminf_{h \to 0^+} \frac{f(x+h) - f(x)}{h} < r.$$

Then for each $\delta > 0$, there exists $0 < h_x < \delta$ such that $h_x^{-1}(f(x + h_x) - f(x)) < r$. Let $\mathcal{F}$ be the collection of $(x, x + h_x)$, where h_x is selected as aforementioned while δ ranges over all positive value, and x ranges over $E_{r,s}$. It is then clear that $\mathcal{F}$ satisfies the condition for the previous lemma.

Apply previous lemma, there exists $I_1, \ldots, I_m \in \mathcal{F}$ disjoint such that

$$\mathcal{L}^1_o\left(E_{r,s} \cap \bigcup_{i=1}^m I_i\right) \geq \mathcal{L}^1_o(E_{r,s}) - \varepsilon, \tag{1}$$

$$\sum_{i=1}^m \mathcal{L}^1(I_i) \leq \mathcal{L}^1_o(E_{r,s}) + \varepsilon. \tag{2}$$

Write $I_i = (x_i, x_i + h_i)$, then

$$\sum_{i=1}^n f(x_i + h_i) - f(x_i) < r \sum_{i=1}^n h_i \leq r\mathcal{L}^1_o(E_{r,s}) + r\varepsilon. \tag{3}$$

Now let $V = \bigcup_{i=1}^{m}(x_i, x_i + h_i)$, which is open. If $x \in E_{r,s} \cap V$, we have

$$s < \limsup_{t \to 0} \frac{f(x+t) - f(x)}{t}.$$

Then for every $\delta > 0$, there exists f_x such that $0 < t_x < \delta$ and $s < t_x^{-1}(f(x + t_x) - f(x))$. Define $\mathcal{G}$ to be the collection of $(x, x + t_x)$ that is contained in V, where t_x is selected as aforementioned while $\delta > 0$ ranges over all positive value, and x ranges over $E_{r,s} \cap V$.

The previous lemma again gives $J_1, \ldots, J_l \in \mathcal{G}$ disjoint such that

$$\mathcal{L}_o^1\left(E_{r,s} \cap V \cap \bigcup_{k=1}^{l} J_k\right) \geq \mathcal{L}_o^1(E_{r,s} \cap V) - \varepsilon.$$

Write $J_k = (y_k, y_k + t_k)$, we have

$$\begin{aligned}\sum_{k=1}^{l} f(y_k + t_k) - f(y_k) &\geq s \sum_{k=1}^{l} t_k \\ &\geq s\mathcal{L}_o^1(E_{r,s} \cap V) - s\varepsilon \\ &\geq s\mathcal{L}_o^1(E_{r,s}) - 2s\varepsilon. \end{aligned} \tag{4}$$

Now compare (3) and (4). Since f is increasing and each J_k lies in one of the interval I_i, it is not hard to see that

$$\sum_{i=1}^{n} f(x_i + h_i) \geq \sum_{k=1}^{l} f(y_k + t_k) - f(y_k).$$

It follows that

$$\mathcal{L}_o^1(E_{r,s}) \leq \frac{2s + r}{s - r}\varepsilon.$$

Letting $\varepsilon \to 0$ completes the proof for $\mathcal{L}^1(E_{r,s}) = 0$. This implies that $f'_+(x)$ exists for a.e. $x \in [a, b]$. Similarly, $f'_-(x)$ exists for a.e. $x \in [a, b]$. A previous lemma shows that the left and right derivatives are equal a.e. Therefore, $f'(x)$ exists a.e.

It remains to show the left and right derivatives are a.e. finite. Define

$$g(x) = \begin{cases} f(x), & x \in [a, b] \\ f(b), & x \geq b. \end{cases}$$

Define also

$$g_n(x) = \frac{g(x + n^{-1}) - g(x)}{n^{-1}}$$

for $x \in [a,b]$ and $n \in \mathbb{N}$. Then, $g_m(x) \to f'(x)$ for a.e. $x \in [a,b]$. Since f is monotone, it is measurable and thus g_m is also measurable. By Fatou's lemma,

$$\begin{aligned}
\int_a^b f'(x)\,dx &\le \liminf_{n\to\infty} \int_a^b g_n(x)\,dx \\
&= \liminf_{n\to\infty} n\left(\int_a^b g(x+n^{-1})\,dx - \int_a^b g(x)\,dx\right) \\
&= \liminf_{n\to\infty} n\left(\int_a^{b-n^{-1}} g(x+n^{-1})\,dx + \int_{b-n^{-1}}^b f(b) - \int_a^b g(x)\,dx\right) \\
&= \liminf_{n\to\infty} n\left(\int_{a+n^{-1}}^b g(t)\,dt - \int_a^b g(t)\,dt\right) + f(b) \\
&= \liminf_{n\to\infty} f(b) - n\int_a^{a+n^{-1}} f(t)\,dt \\
&\le f(b) - f(a).
\end{aligned}$$

Therefore, f' is integrable, which implies $\{f' = \infty\}$ has measure zero.

For a general interval $I \subset \mathbb{R}$, I can be written as a countable union of bounded interval, the proof for the theorem is complete. □

Remark. From the proof above, we see that for monotone function $f : [a,b] \to \mathbb{R}$, we have

$$\int_a^b f' \le f(b) - f(a).$$

There exists a monotone function for which inequality is strict. Indeed, let $f : [0,1] \to [0,1]$ be the Cantor function. Then, $f' = 0$ a.e. but $f(1) = 1$ and $f(0) = 0$.

1.2 Differentiation of BV functions

Definition (pointwise variation)**.** Let $I \subset \mathbb{R}$ be an interval and $f : I \to \mathbb{R}^N$. The **pointwise variation** of f on the interval I is defined as

$$\operatorname{Var} f = \sup\left\{\sum_{i=1}^n \|f(x_i) - f(x_{i-1})\|\right\},$$

where the supremum is taken over all partition $x_0 < x_1 < \cdots < x_n$, where $n \in \mathbb{N}$ and $x_0, \ldots, x_n \in I$. Say a function has **bounded pointwise variation** if $\operatorname{Var} f < \infty$.

The space of all functions $f : I \to \mathbb{R}^N$ with bounded pointwise variation is denoted by $BV(I;\mathbb{R}^N)$.

Proposition. The following properties holds:

1. Fix $c \in I$, then
$$\|f\|_{BV} = \operatorname{Var} f + \|f(c)\|$$
is a norm on $BV(I;\mathbb{R}^N)$. Moreover, $BV(I;\mathbb{R}^N)$ is complete under this norm.
2. Let $c \in I$, then
$$\operatorname*{Var}_I f = \operatorname*{Var}_{I\cap(-\infty,c]} f + \operatorname*{Var}_{I\cap[c,\infty)} f.$$

Proof. Exercise. □

Definition. Let $f : I \to \mathbb{R}^N$. Say f has **locally bounded variation** if $\operatorname{Var}_{[a,b]} f < \infty$ for all $[a,b] \subset I$. Denote the space of functions with bounded local variation as $BV_{\text{loc}}(I;\mathbb{R}^N)$.

Example. Let $f : I \to \mathbb{R}^N$ is Lipshitz continuous with Lipshitz constant L, $[a,b] \subset I$, and $a \le x_0 < x_1 < \cdots < x_n < b$. Then,
$$\sum_{i=1}^{n} \|f(x_i) - f(x_{i-1})\| \le L \sum_{i=1}^{n} (x_i - x_{i-1}) \le L(b-a).$$
Therefore, Lipshitz functions has locally bounded variation.

Exercise. Let $f, g \in BV([a,b])$, then the following holds:

1. $fg \in BV([a,b])$,
2. Further suppose $g \neq 0$, then fg^{-1} needs not be in $BV([a,b])$. However, if there exists $c > 0$ such that $g(x) \ge c$ for all $x \in I$, we have $fg^{-1} \in BV([a,b])$.

Theorem. Let $I \subset \mathbb{R}$ be an interval and $f : I \to \mathbb{R}$ increasing. Then,
$$\operatorname{Var} f = \sup f - \inf f.$$
In particular, $f \in BV_{\text{loc}}(I)$, and if f is bounded, $f \in BV(I)$.

Proof. Let $x_0 < x_1 < \cdots < x_n$ be a partition of I, then
$$\sum_{i=1}^{n} |f(x_i) - f(x_{i-1})| = f(x_n) - f(x_0) \le \sup f - \inf f.$$
Hence, $\operatorname{Var} f \le \sup f - \inf f$. Conversely, assume $\inf I < \sup I$ and take $\inf I < a < b < \sup I$. Then, we have $f(b) - f(a) \le \operatorname{Var} f$. Letting $a \to \inf I$ and $b \to \sup I$ completes the proof. □

Theorem. Let $I \subset \mathbb{R}$ be an interval and $f : I \to \mathbb{R}^N$. Fix $c \in I$ and define
$$v(x) = \begin{cases} \operatorname{Var}_{[c,x]} f & (x \ge c), \\ -\operatorname{Var}_{[x,c]} f & (x < c). \end{cases}$$
Then, for every $x, y \in I$ with $x < y$, $\|f(x) - f(y)\| \le v(y) - v(x)$.

Moreover, if $f \in BV_{\text{loc}}(I; \mathbb{R}^N)$, then the left and right limit exists for all $x \in I^\circ$, and f is continuous at all but countably many points. Also, if $N = 1$, $v \pm f$ are increasing.

Proof. Let $x < y$, then

$$\|f(y) - f(x)\| \le \operatorname*{Var}_{[x,y]} f = \begin{cases} \operatorname{Var}_{[c,y]} f - \operatorname{Var}_{[c,x]} f & (c \le x < y), \\ \operatorname{Var}_{[x,c]} f - \operatorname{Var}_{[y,c]} f & (x < y \le c), \\ \operatorname{Var}_{[x,c]} f + \operatorname{Var}_{[c,y]} f & (x \le c \le y). \end{cases}$$

It directly follows that $\|f(x) - f(y)\| \le v(y) - v(x)$.

Now assume $f \in BV_{\text{loc}}(I; \mathbb{R}^N)$, then v is real-valued. Now that v is increasing, so v is continuous at all but countably many points. It directly follows that f is continuous at all but countably many points.

For $N = 1$, we have $|f(x) - f(y)| \le v(y) - v(x)$, so $f(x) - f(y) \le v(y) - v(x)$ and $f(y) - f(x) \le v(y) - v(x)$, showing that $v \pm f$ are increasing. □

Corollary. Let $I \subset \mathbb{R}$ be an interval, then

1. $BV_{\text{loc}}(I)$ is the smallest vector space that contains all monotone functions $f : I \to \mathbb{R}$.
2. $BV(I)$ is the smallest vector space that contains all $f : I \to \mathbb{R}$ that is bounded and monotone.

Proof. 1. By previous theorems, $BV_{\text{loc}}(I)$ contains all monotone functions. Conversely, for any $f \in BV_{\text{loc}}(I)$, we have

$$f = v + (f - v),$$

where both functions are monotone.

2. Similar.

□

Corollary. If $f \in BV_{\text{loc}}(I)$, then f is differentiable a.e.

1.3 Absolutely continuous functions

Definition (absolutely continuous)**.** Let $I \subset \mathbb{R}$ be an interval. Say $f : I \to \mathbb{R}^N$ is **absolutely continuous** if for every $\varepsilon > 0$, there exists $\delta > 0$ such that for any finite collection of intervals $\{[a_i, b_i]\}_{i=1}^n$ with $[a_i, b_i] \subset I$ and disjoint interior, and $\sum_{i=1}^n (b_i - a_i) \le \delta$, we have $\sum_{i=1}^n \|f(b_i) - f(a_i)\| \le \varepsilon$.

Remark. Note that taking $n = 1$ in the previous definition gives uniform continuity. Therefore absolute continuity implies uniform continuity.

Example. Let $f : I \to \mathbb{R}^N$ be Lipshitz continuous with constant L, then $\sum_{i=1}^n \|f(b_i) - f(a_i)\| \leq L \sum_{i=1}^n (b_i - a_i)$. Therefore, Lipshitz continuity implies absolute continuity.

Theorem. Let $I \subset \mathbb{R}$ be an interval and $f : I \to \mathbb{R}^N$ absolutely continuous. Suppose $f' = 0$ a.e. Then, f is constant.

Example. The Cantor function has zero derivative a.e. but it is not constant, so it is not absolutely continuous.

Proof. Let $a < b \in I$. We want to show that $f(a) = f(b)$. Let

$$G = \{x \in (a, b) : f'(x) = 0\}.$$

It follows that $\mathcal{L}^1(G) = b - a$. For any $x \in G$, we have $h^{-1}(f(x+h) - f(x)) \to 0$ as $h \to 0$. Given $\varepsilon > 0$, there exists $h_x > 0$ such that $\left\|h^{-1}(f(x+h) - f(x))\right\| \leq \varepsilon$ for all $0 < |h| \leq h_x$. Now let

$$\mathcal{F} = \{(x, x+h) : x \in G, 0 < h < h_x\}.$$

By a previous lemma, for any $\delta > 0$, there exists a finite and disjoint collection of intervals $\{(x_i, x_i + h_i)\}_{i=1}^n \subset \mathcal{F}$ with

$$\begin{aligned}
\mathcal{L}_o^1\left(G \cap \bigcup_{i=1}^n (x_i, x_i + h_i)\right) &\geq \mathcal{L}_o^1(G) - \delta, \\
\sum_{i=1}^n \mathcal{L}^1((x_i, x_i + h_i)) &\leq \mathcal{L}_o^1(G) + \delta.
\end{aligned}$$

Let $x_1 < \cdots < x_n$. It follows that

$$\begin{aligned}
\sum_{i=1}^n h_i &\geq \mathcal{L}_o^1\left(G \cap \bigcup_{i=1}^n (x_i, x_i + h_i)\right) \\
&\geq b - a - \delta.
\end{aligned}$$

Therefore, $(a, x_1) \cup (x_1 + h_1, x_2) \cup \cdots \cup (x_n + h_n, b)$ has measure at most δ. By absolutely continuity, we have

$$\|f(x_1) - f(a)\| + \|f(x_1 + h_1) + f(x_2)\| + \cdots + \|f(b) - f(x_n + h_n)\| \leq \varepsilon.$$

Moreover, $\|f(x_i + h_i) - f(x_i)\| \leq \varepsilon h_i$. It follows that

$$\begin{aligned}
\|f(b) - f(a)\| &\leq \varepsilon + \sum_{i=1}^n \varepsilon h_i \\
&\leq \varepsilon + \varepsilon(b - a) + \delta.
\end{aligned}$$

Letting $\delta \to 0$ and $\varepsilon \to 0$ shows $f(b) = f(a)$. □

Theorem. Let $I \subset \mathbb{R}$ be an interval and $f : I \to \mathbb{R}^N$ be absoultely continuous. Then, $f \in BV_{\text{loc}}(I; \mathbb{R}^N)$. In particular, f is differentiable a.e.

Proof. Let $[a, b] \in I$. Let δ be in the definition of absolute continuity when applying it to f with $\varepsilon = 1$. Divide interval $[a, b]$ into segments of length δ. Call the segments $\{[x_{i-1}, x_i]\}_{i=1}^n$, where $n \leq \delta^{-1}(b - a) + 1 < \infty$. It follows that

$$\operatorname*{Var}_{[a,b]} f = \sum_{i=1}^{n} \operatorname*{Var}_{[x_{i-1},x_i]} f \leq n < \infty,$$

completing the proof. □

Theorem (FTC for Lipshitz functions)**.** Let $I \subset \mathbb{R}$ be an interval and $f : I \to \mathbb{R}$ be Lipshitz. Then,

$$f(b) - f(a) = \int_a^b f'(x)\,dx.$$

Proof. Note that f being Lipshitz implies $f \in BV_{\text{loc}}(I)$, so f is differentiable a.e. Define

$$g(x) = \begin{cases} f(x) & (a \leq x \leq b), \\ f(b) & (x \geq b). \end{cases}$$

Note that g is still Lipshitz and let L be the Lipshitz constant. We have

$$\lim_{n\to\infty} \frac{g(x + n^{-1}) - g(x)}{n^{-1}} = g'(x) \text{ a.e.}$$

Since g is continuous, g' is measurable. Moreover, g being Lipshitz implies $|g'| \leq L$. It then follows from DCT that

$$\lim_{n\to\infty} \int_a^b \frac{g(x + n^{-1}) - g(x)}{n^{-1}}\,dx = \int_a^b g'(x)\,dx.$$

Through similar computation as in the Lebesgue differentiation theorem, for LHS we have

$$\begin{aligned} \lim_{n\to\infty} \int_a^b \frac{g(x + n^{-1}) - g(x)}{n^{-1}}\,dx &= \lim_{n\to\infty} f(b) - n \int_a^{a+n^{-1}} f(t)\,dt \\ &= f(b) - f(a), \end{aligned}$$

where the last equality is by continuity of f. □

Remark. Comparing this with the proof of Lebesgue differentiation theorem for monotone function, we know f is continuous and Lipshitz. Lipshitz continuity gives us bounded derivative and the ability to use DCT, and continuity let us know the final term is $f(a)$.